Aspects of Attitude Formation

Objectives of chapter 4



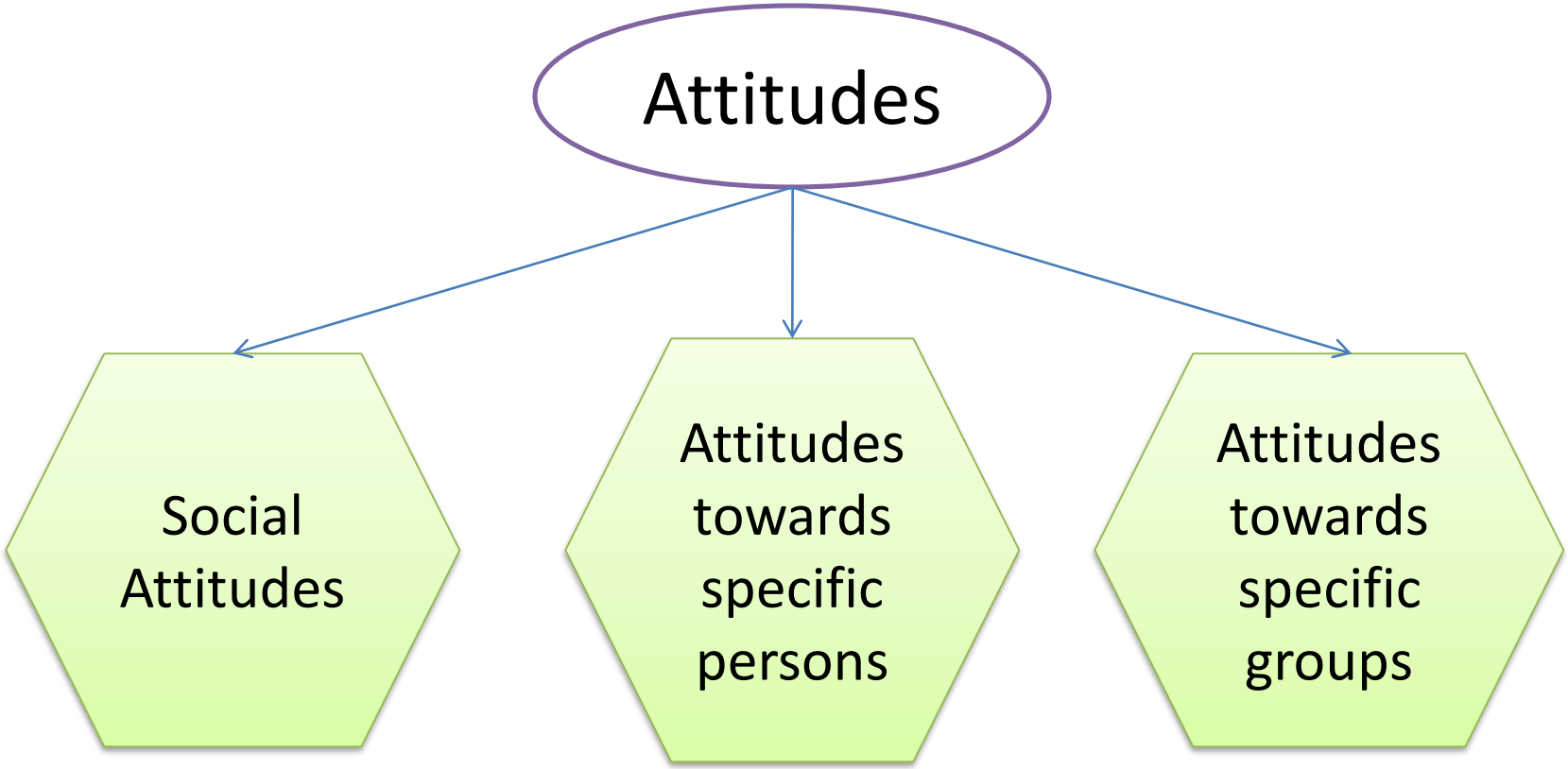
- Attitude formation
- Attitude influence and guidance on behavior
- Attitude persuasion

Attitude

"Attitudes refer to a mental and neural set of readiness, organized through experience exerting a directing or dynamic influence upon the individual's response to all objects and situations with which it is related." -Gordon Allport.

People's evaluation of almost any aspect of the world.

Types of Attitudes



Attitude

- Explicit attitudes - conscious and reportable.

- Implicit attitudes—uncontrollable and perhaps not consciously accessible to us.
  - Implicit Association Test (IAT)

Attitude Formation: How Attitudes Develop?

Classical conditioning

- unconditioned stimulus
- conditioned stimulus
- unconditioned response
- conditioned response

- Direct & indirect route
- Subliminal conditioning
- Mere exposure effect – illusion of truth effect

Attitude Formation: How Attitudes Develop?

Instrumental conditioning - differential rewards and punishments.





Attitude Formation: How Attitudes Develop?

Observational learning - when individuals acquire attitudes or behaviors simply by observing others.

- Social comparison

https://www.facebook.com/LADbible/videos/little-girl-pretends-to-be-on-the-phone/281045812546448/

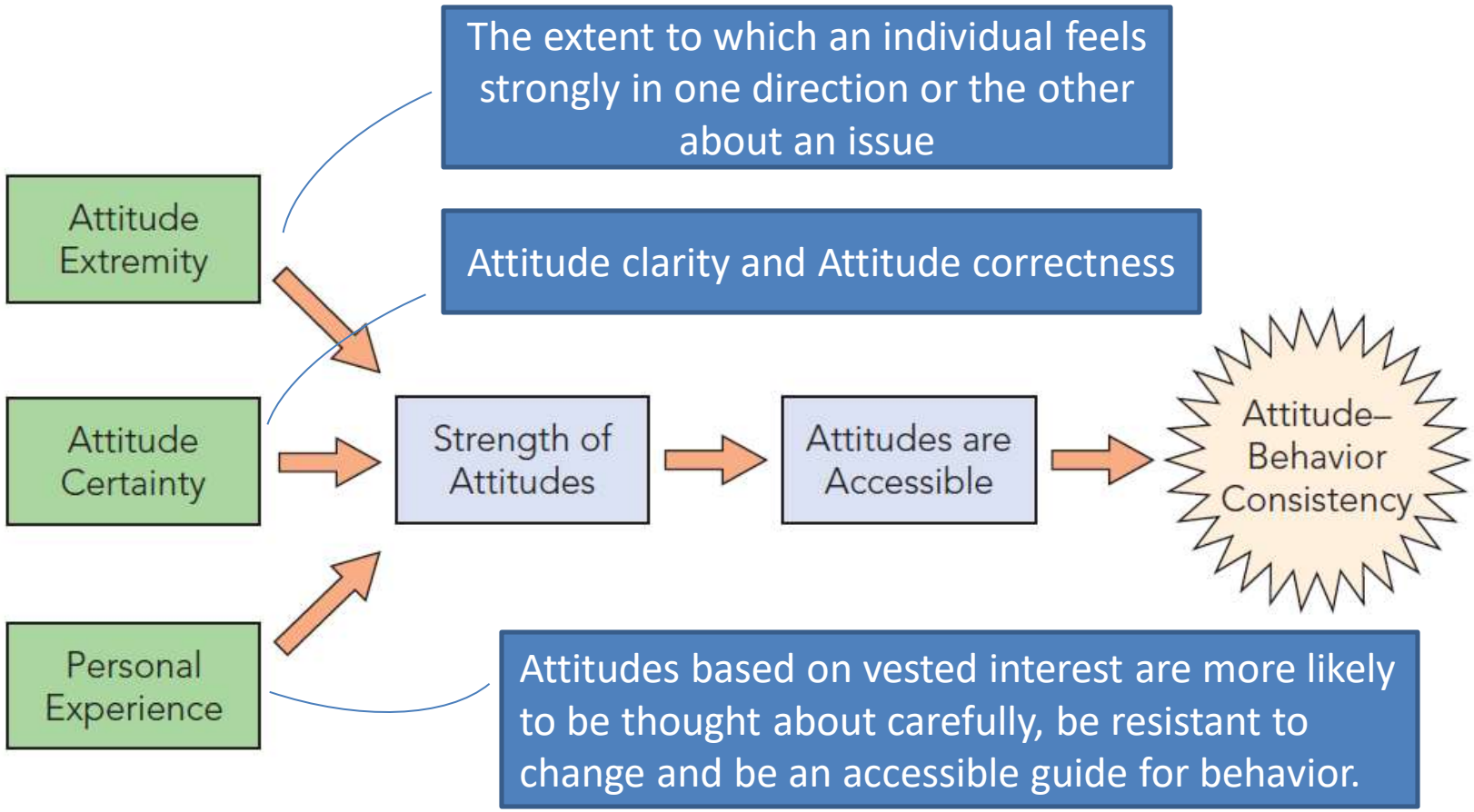
When and Why Do Attitudes Influence Behavior?

- Lapiere(1934) conducted a study to understand the attitude behaviour link by travelling with a young Chinese couple.

- Results indicate a sizeable gap between attitudes and behaviour between what people say and what they do.

Attitude Behaviour Link

- Pluralistic ignorance

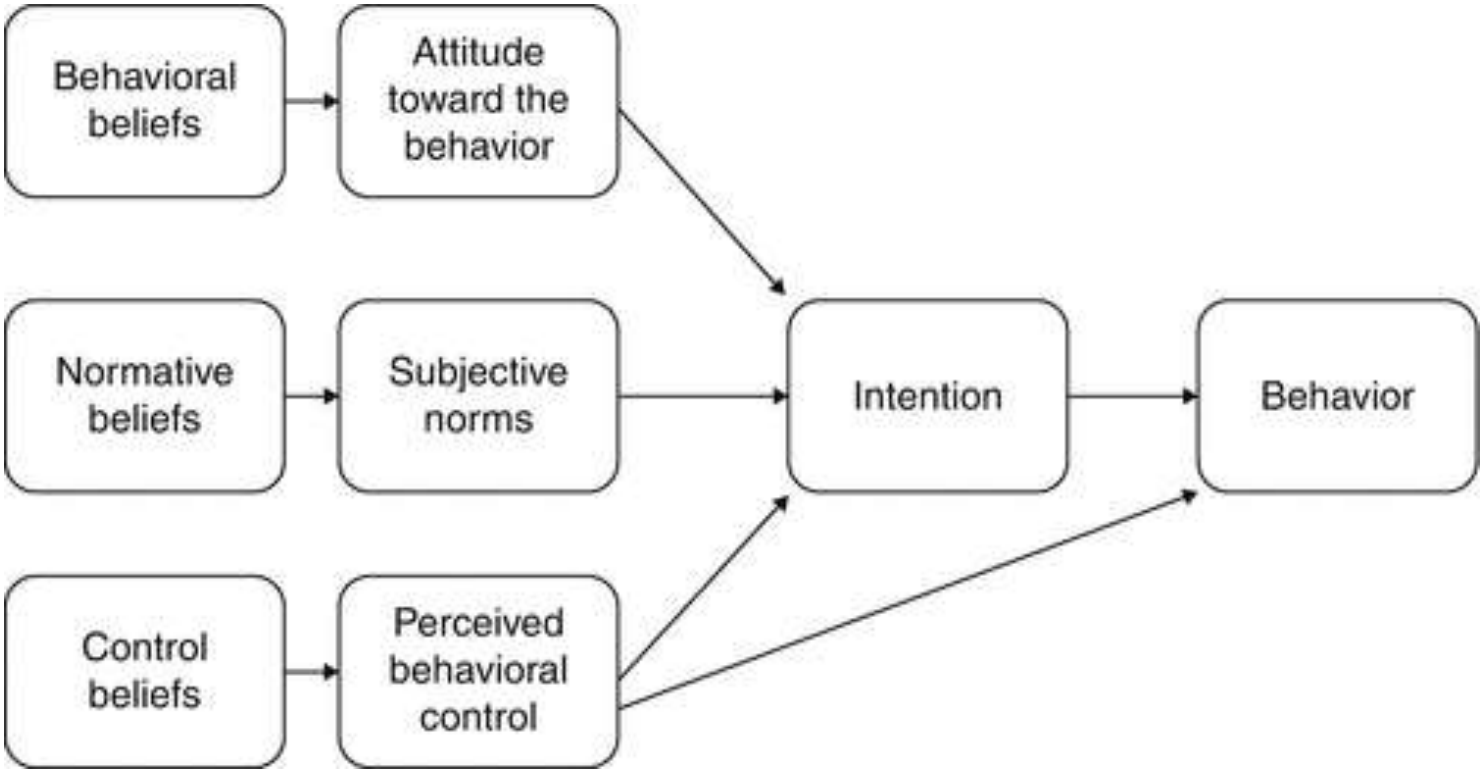


Emotions and Attitude Formation

(Read the article)

How Do Attitudes Guide Behavior?

- The theory of reasoned action (TRA)
- The theory of planned behavior (TPB)



Attitudes and Spontaneous Behavioral Reactions

- Fazio's 1990 attitude-to-behavior process model
- Habit formation

Reference

Text book

- Baron, R.A. & Branscombe, N.R. (2012). *Social Psychology.* (13th ed.). Pearson Education, Inc.